



ACHANTA DURING ONE OF HIS TRAINING SESSIONS

talked into starting the Jude Felix Hockey Academy (JFHA) by Father John Anthony. Soon some of the game's icons—Dhanraj Pillai, Sabu Varghese, Ashish Ballal, Anil Aldren and even Rahul Dravid—landed at the orphanage grounds to help the children master the skills.

Whenever Felix comes to Bangalore from Singapore, where he currently coaches, the young hockey players get hands-on training from the Olympian. Now affiliated to the Karnataka State Hockey Association, JFHA is giving the children several opportunities to play in big tournaments. In his halting English, Kumar, who wakes up at 5 a.m. and sleeps only at 10 p.m. every day, says, "One day we hope to repay these great men by playing for the country." But with the national game most often getting the stick in India, the current scenario is anything but promising for youngsters for whom it's an escape from destiny.

by Stephen David

Future Doctors Bhopal

Looking for a Cure

DREAM

To practice medicine in rural India

The narrow flight of stairs is odd and inconvenient. But a group of Class XI pre-medical test hopefuls has been climbing these religiously to attend Durrani's Zoology classes in Bhopal for the past six months where they are greeted with an overhead projector and loudspeakers, as if amplifying their hopes. There's Shreya Sharma, 16, from nearby Vidisha, who wants to live the dream of her father who could not become a doctor. There's Divya Rath, 16, who's come from Angul in Orissa and attends a local school nearby just to be coached here. Yet another, Kartikeya Singh, also 16, just wants to do what both his parents are doing.

A student is required to spend anywhere between Rs 50,000 and Rs 70,000 for 10 months just on the coaching classes. The total expenditure can touch Rs 1.5 to Rs 2 lakh depending on lodging and food expenses. But money is the last thing on the minds of these potential doctors. Or so it would seem. "There are two distinct Indias. While one is

wealthy, the other, bigger section is not. We want to serve the needy," says Singh. Moreover, most of them do not wish to work with big corporate hospital chains after becoming doctors. "I want to create rural awareness on health issues. After all, Third World diseases like cholera and malaria still plague India," says Divya Tripathi, 16. It's an idealism that sounds out of touch with these mercenary times. Perhaps it is the expectations of their parents or their own inherent fear of the unknown, but these youngsters, such as Palak Jain, daughter of a dentist, are quite content to be Mr and Ms MBBS.

by Ambresh Mishra

"There are two distinct Indias. We don't want to serve the wealthy but those who need us."

KARTIKEYA SINGH

Student

MEDICAL ASPIRANTS AT A COACHING CLASS

